

#TeamsNation

Autism, Teams & Socials

Dennie Declercq



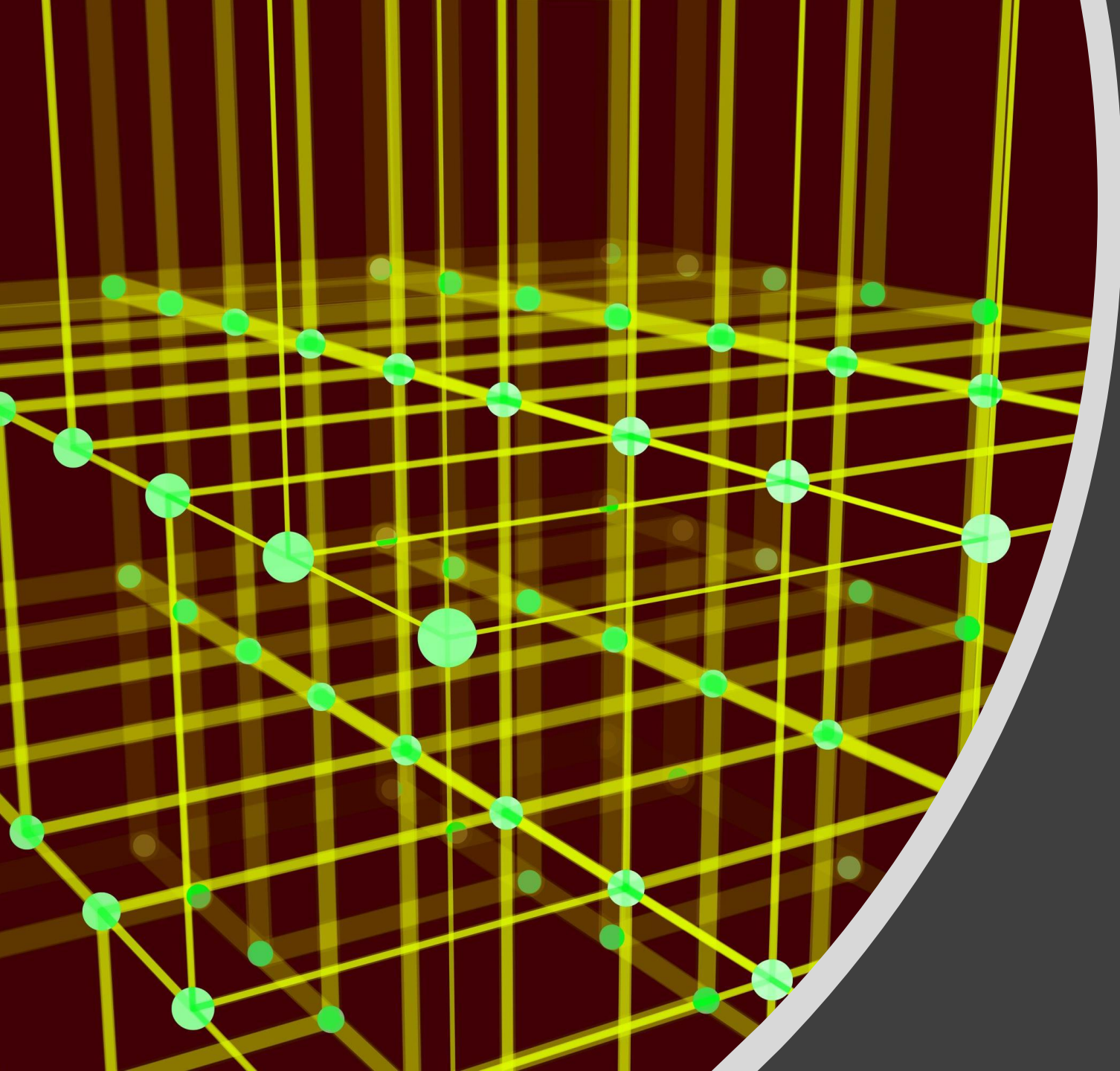
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Microsoft Teams



Microsoft Tech Community



Intro



Who am I?

- Dennie Declercq
- Developer & President DDSOft
- Microsoft MVP
- #DreamingIsBelieving
- @DennieDeclercq

Content

Intro

Prequel

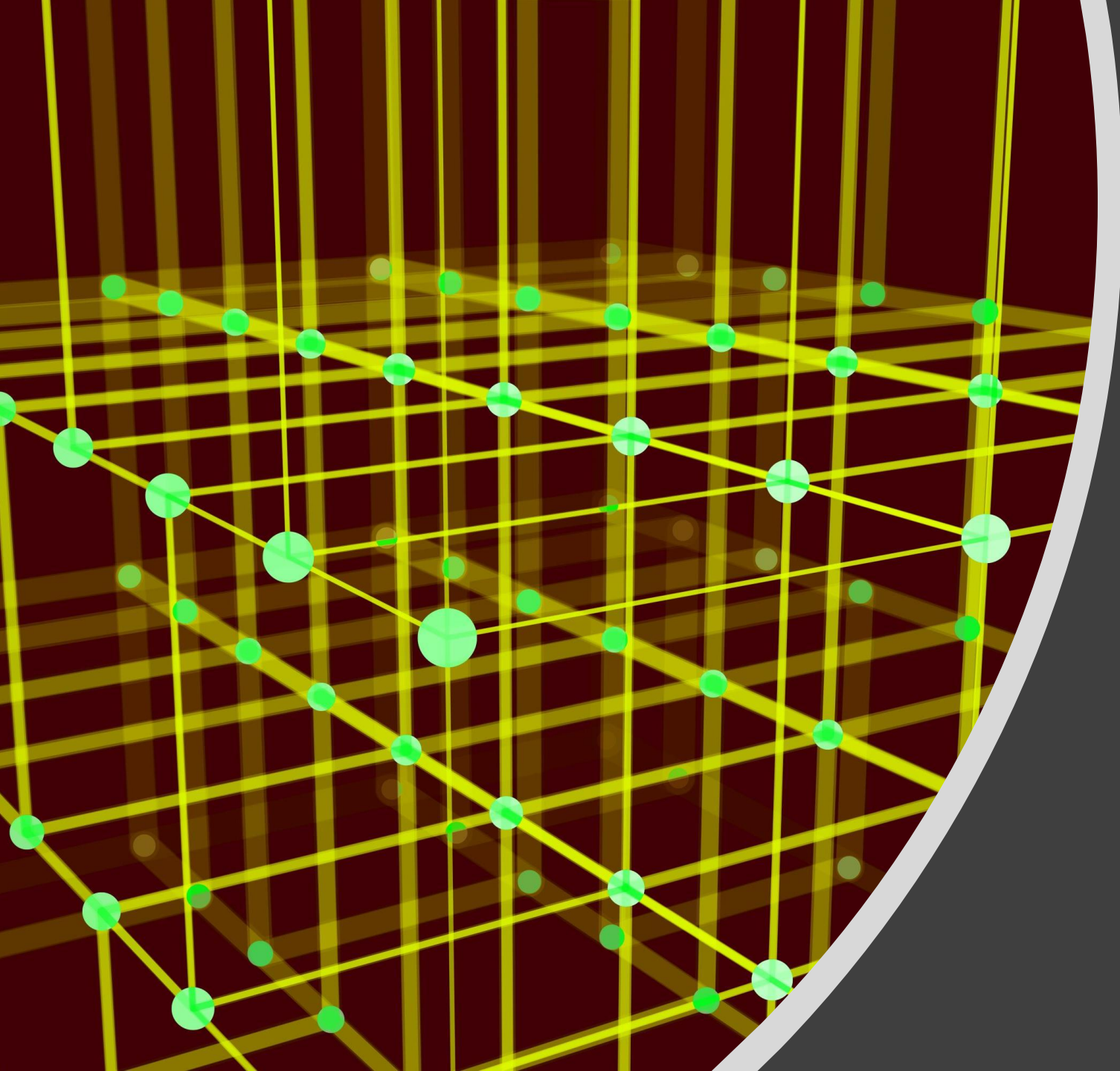
Autism & MS Teams

Social Fun & MS Teams

To be Hybrid

Thanks // Q&A





Prequel

DDSoft & MS Teams

DDSoft

- Connection social industry and IT
- IT-coaching mindset
- Understands needs of social industry
- 4 Volunteers (3 p.w. Autism)

MS Teams history

- Started with MS Teams
 - Quite from the start
 - Administration
 - Hybrid meetings in team
 - Sharing of documents
- No SharePoint knowledge needed
- Really easy



The Pandemic

Me, myself

- Increase of anxiety
 - (Severe)
- Missed in person conferences
 - Like hell
- Working for customers
 - An escape
- Virtual conferences
 - Better than boredom

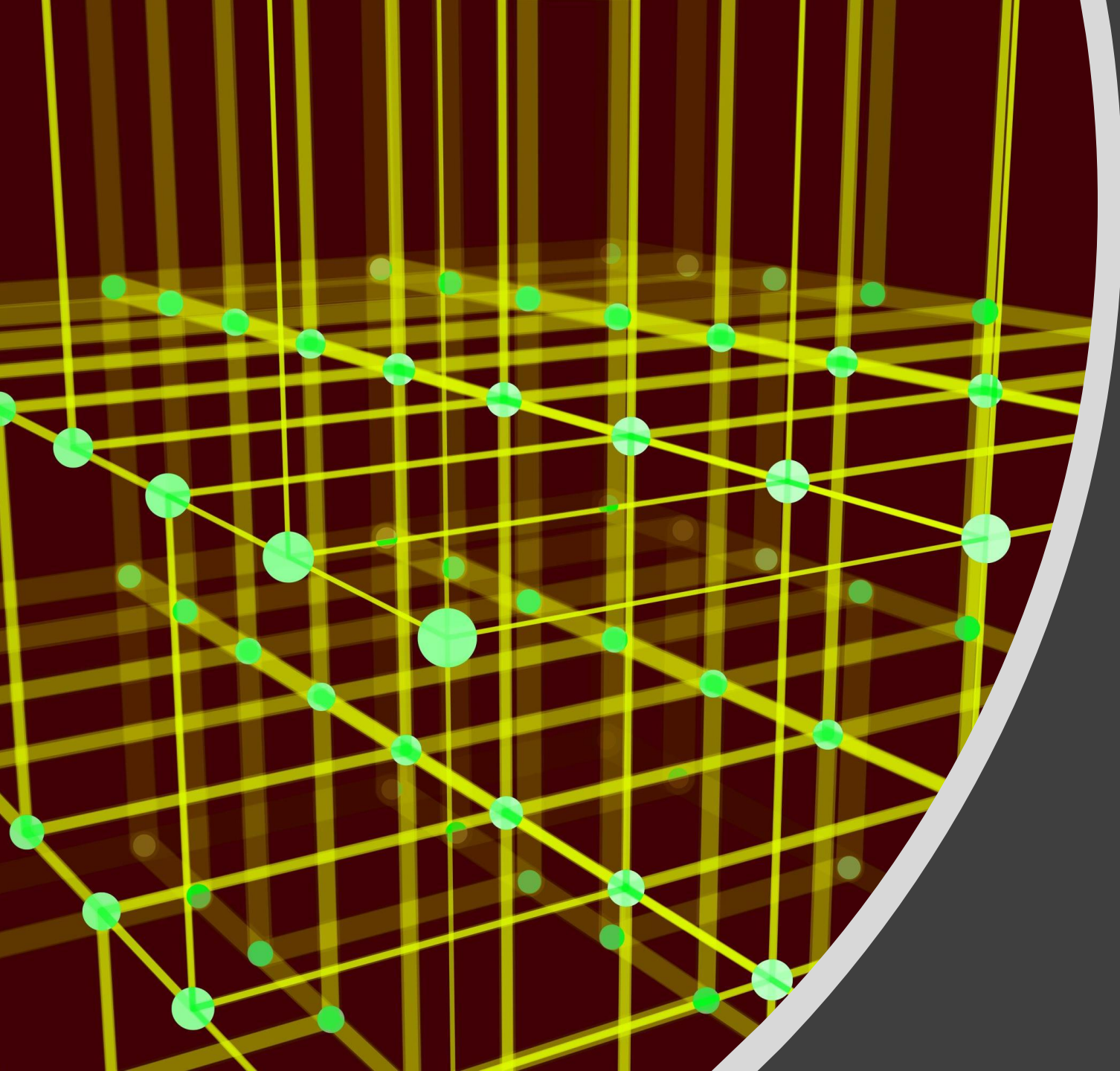
DDSoft

- Announcement of Teams knowledge
 - Huge increase customers
 - Virtual host
- Increase of budget
- Finally known in Belgium
- Start of methodology 'IT-Coaching'

The need for social contact

- People are social species
- Myself, I am extroverted
- Even introverted people missed folks
- A virtual meeting is not the same as a webinar
- People are in search of connections
- Mental health issues coming up due to loneliness





Autism & MS Teams

Virtual Backgrounds

Pro

- Hide of social environment
 - Poverty
- Privacy
- Branding

Contra

- Contrast
 - 'People pasted' on the background
 - Overlay and stuff

Eye contact

AWE!

Something great about the pandemic



Serious topics

Difficult

No feeling of connection

Less non-verbal feedback

Feedback loop of trust

**“The first meetings with my (autism)
coach
were awful!”**

- Dennie Declercq



Cam on or cam off?

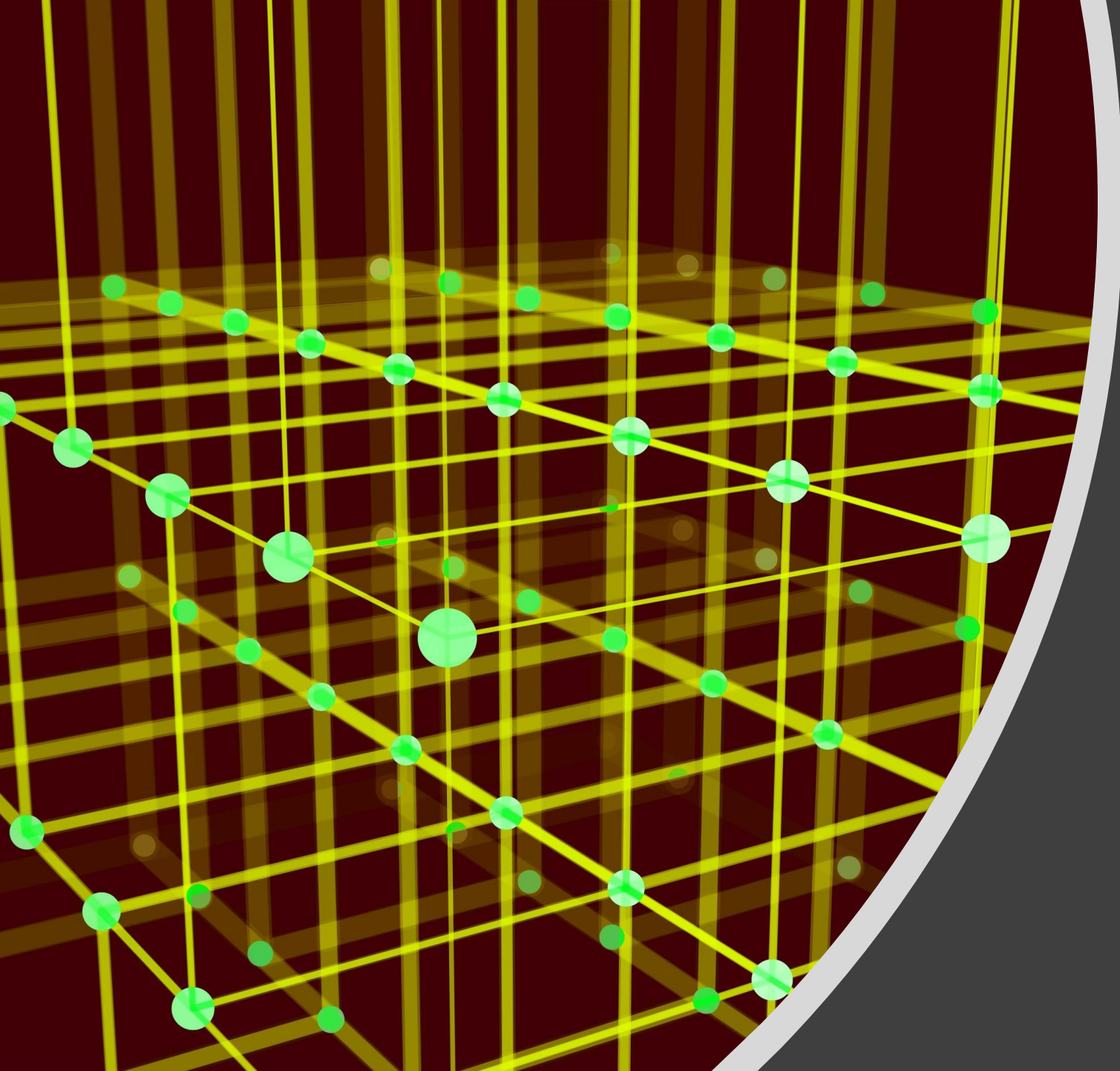
Cam On

- More nonverbal feedback
- More attention
 - Attention control
- Less people joining

Cam Off

- No nonverbal feedback AT ALL
- More people joining
- Less trust
- Some people too shy to cam

- NOTE: Here we speak about
- Non (professional) work related topics
 - Autism Self support user groups
 - Virtual (non/ semi professional) get togethers



Social Fun & MS Teams

- Open Houses (Virtual Pub Nights)
- Self Support groups (Alcohol, Autism, parents with lost child)

Login

- No “spontaneous ad hoc” login
 - People in MS Teams tenant are easier
 - In the beginning NEEDED
 - There are errors, by “non experienced” users
 - Even if they are in the team environment

NOTE: Here we speak about

- Teams usage March 2020 – March 2021
- During Fall 2021 general improvements



To drink or not to drink?

- Heavy LinkedIn topic Anno 2020 (and +)
 - For social gatherings OK
 - Virtual Pubs (aka Open Houses)
 - After drink (after a community talk)
 - Birthday party
- It's not **WHICH TOOL** you use but **WHAT** you do and which **ATMOSPHERE**
 - Work
 - Free time
 - Family

PJs & DJ's

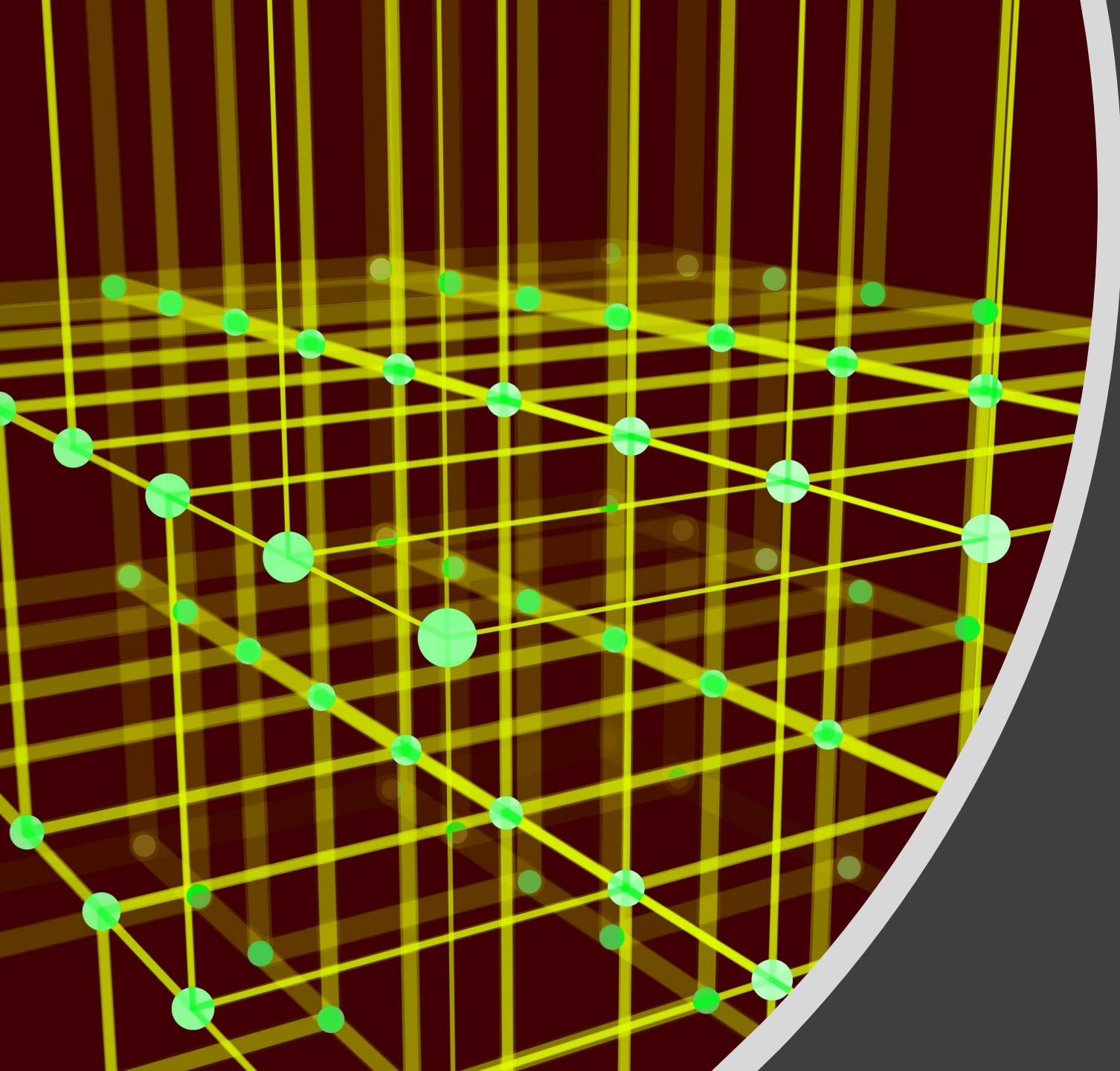
- Did you try (I did)?
 - DJ/ Music gatherings
 - Online escape games
 - Word games?
 - Quizzes
 - Get togethers in PJ
 - Video calls until 3 am

Virtual Coffees

- With family
 - Non tech users
 - Just about random stuff
 - Seeing our grand...
 - Seeing family

Trust & Safety

- Microsoft Teams is the safest video conference tool
 - Perfect where privacy is needed
 - For 2 customers a BIG PLUS comparing to Zoom even login was difficult for some users



To be..
Hybrid

Autism meetup

- Advantages not needing to take public transport
- Not needed to be long away from home
- More accessible

Some people in person
Some people joining virtual



Kinect & Lectures

- We do dream:
 - External speakers
 - Kinect device faced on in person audience
 - Additional screen to see home audience

Thanks || Q&A



- dennie@ddsoft.be
- @DennieDeclercq
- #DreamingIsBelieving
- Slides:
- <https://go.ddsoft.be/AutismTeamsAndSocials>

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session

1



Attend more
sessions and
join our
keynotes at
19.00 CET

2



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3

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